Teambuilding

European Youth Parliament
Sweden
Finland

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European Youth Parliament
EYP-Finland
The National Committee

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- And many more!

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A guide to different kinds of games

Teambuilding activities are loads of fun, but they are also tools for strengthening your group. They can be good icebreakers for the beginning of a meeting or a way to bond and have fun with members you know. Some involve a lot of teamwork and can result in tighter friendships among the people you work with to save the environment.
There are many different kinds of teambuilding activities and we have broken them down into a few rough categories. Keep in mind that some activities are low intensity and some are high intensity.

Name Games

Warm Ups

Ice Breakers
These include games or activities you would use at teambuilding and the first meetings or at the beginning of a meeting. These usually involve little touching because too much physical contact among people you don't know can be uncomfortable for many people. These games help loosen people up and make them more comfortable with people they've just met.

Energisers
An energiser is a method you use when the group or an individual is low on energy, out of focus or stressed. Even a very short energizer, lasting only a few minutes, can change the atmosphere in the group. It often creates a good laugh and helps solving problems when a group disagrees or is stuck in a discussion.
Energisers have different purposes and it is very important that you are aware of what sort of effect you want to reach when you decide which energizer you want to use.
These activities/games are for when people are more comfortable with each other. People aren't as concerned about looking silly as long as other people are doing it too. More touchy games are sometimes ok, but this must be gauged by watching the participants and their reactions. Sometimes these are good for the end of a meeting.

Trust

Communication / Cooperation

Projects / Planning / Problem Solving

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Name Games

Name

Sit in a circle. The first person says his or her name. Then the second person says his or her name and also says the first person's name again, and so on all the way around the circle. The last person which should be you has to repeat everyone's name.

Names and action

Make a standing circle. Have one person start by saying an action and their name. The action should start with the same letter as their name, so "Energetic Eric, Jumping Josephine". When they say their action and name, they can also act out their action. So "Jumping Josephine" would jump up and down. You can have the each just say their name and action or you could have each subsequent person repeat the action and names of the people before them and then add theirs on. It depends on how self-conscience the group is.

Name and adjective

Student gives an adjective before their name. The adjective the delegate chooses should start with the same letter with which their first names begin. As always, the more motion involved, the better. For example: *Catastrophic Christopher, Daring Daniel, Petrified Peter, or Rockin' Robin.*

Name and ball

Stand in a circle and take a small ball and throw it across the circle. The person holding the ball says the name of someone in group and rolls or tosses the ball to that person. That person catches the ball and is to say the name of the person he or she is throwing the ball to. It helps to go around the circle once so everyone can say their name.

Name and personal fact

Sit in a circle. The first person says his or her name and a one sentence personal fact (favourite food, earliest memory, address, etc.) The second person repeats the first delegate's name and sentence and adds his or her own name and sentence. The third delegate repeats the first two names and sentences and adds his own, etc.
Each delegate takes, in exact order, all that has gone before and adds his own name and sentence until the game goes around the entire circle. The last person which should be you has to repeat everyone's name.
Delegates then change places within the circle and one volunteer attempts to give the names and sentences for everyone in this new order.

Name and sign

Get in a circle. Each delegate states their name and creates a sign with their body that in some way represents them or a specific subject such as animals. After the delegates share their name and sign, they must repeat the name and sign of those who have gone before. If you as the leader of the group go first and make a crazy/weird sign, it may encourage the delegates to do the same.

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Warm Ups

Ball in group

Procedure:
The ball has to touch everyone in the committee in the shortest possible time.

Equipment: A ball and a stop-watch.

Interviewing

Purpose:
This is a good game to break the chill - especially if the group doesn't know each other well.

Procedure:
Delegates divide into pairs and interview each other. After that they brief the committee what they found out.

Variation:
You can ask them for example find out 3 things they have in common, or perhaps formulate three interesting statements about the person of which one lie. See "Two truths and a lie" –game.

Equipment: None.

Two truths and a lie

Purpose:
This is a good game to break the chill - especially if the group doesn't know each other well.

Procedure:
Each person has to tell two truths about themselves and one lie, while the others try to guess which is the lie. The key is to make the truths as outrageous as the lies so they are believable.

Variation:
When they've got to know each other better this is a possible variation. Each delegate is asked three questions by the rest of the committee. Two questions must be responded to truthfully, and one response must be a lie. Nobody for certain knows which is which except for the person answering the questions.

Equipment: None.

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Icebreakers / Energisers

Blind Animal Game

Procedure:
Everyone is blindfolded and gets down on hands and knees (to crawl.) After blindfolding, each person is given the name of an animal that makes some distinctive sound (like a pig, horse, lion, snake etc) Names should be assigned in pairs, so that there are two of every animal. The goal is then for each "animal" to find its pair!

Equipment: None.

Blip Blop

Procedure:
Everybody stands in a circle. A pen (or an other small object) is passed from hand to hand in this way:

- This is a Blip
- A what?
- That is a Blip.

The person who receives it, passes it on by saying the same, but it is only the first person who knows what is really is so it is always going back to the first person. At the same time another pen is passed on the other way, this pen is called Blop. Every body needs to be quite aware and awake.

Equipment: A small object (e.g. a pen).

Buzzing Bees

Procedure:
All the delegates are blindfolded and are walking in a rectangular plane saying an "mmm" sound. The facilitator knocks on one delegate who is then allowed to open his or her eyes and stop saying "mmm". The other delegates' task is to find the quiet, sighted person. The ones who find the group of sighted people also become quiet and sighted. They are not allowed to talk until everyone in the group has found his or her way to them.

Equipment: Blindfolds.

Cat And Mouse

Procedure:
Form pairs. Each of the pairs links arms. Choose a pair who will start the game. Choose one to be the cat, and give him or her the ball. The other is the mouse. The cat attempts to catch the mouse and tag it with the ball. If the cat succeeds, the ball changes hands: the mouse becomes the cat and vice versa. The mouse can become safe by linking arms with any one of the pairs. The member of the pair that did not get linked to then becomes the mouse and is forced to unlink. That person, of course, can link to another pair. Play this game when everyone is too wild. It's pretty tiring.

Equipment: A ball.

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Copy Cat

Purpose:
This is an exercise of focus and motion.

Procedure:
The committee is formed into a circle, and one delegate is asked to volunteer to be the "guesser". The guesser goes out of the circle and walks about 10–15 metres away (or goes behind a wall or tree if available.) The guesser then closes his or her eyes. The idea is for the guesser to be unable to see what the rest of the circle is doing or to hear what they are saying. Among the rest of the circle, a delegate volunteers or is chosen to lead the group. The leader then begins making a motion and everyone else copies it. They do so, using any part of their entire body. Someone then yell to the guesser that the group is ready. The guesser comes back and stands in the middle of the circle. The object is for the guesser to guess who the leader is. The leader can change the motion, and everyone else follows. It works best if not everyone looks at the leader. The guesser gets three guesses to guess who the leader is. If he or she guesses correctly, the person who started the motion is the one who is removed from the space for the next round.
After a third incorrect guess, the leader reveals him or her.

Equipment: None.

Do This, Do That !

Procedure:
This is played in the same way as Simon Says except that the leader proceeds his or her orders with either "Do this" or "Do that". If the command is "Do this", then all the players should copy his or her actions. If it is "Do that", then they should remain still.

Equipment: None.

Fill The Gap

Procedure:
The players stand in a large circle. One player walks around the outside of the circle and touches a player on the shoulder. Then both of these players must run around the circle in the same direction in order to reach the gap in the circle. If the player whose shoulder was touched catches the other one he or she must walk around the outside of the circle and touch someone else.

Equipment: None.

Fruit Salad

Purpose:
Excellent in committee work when you want delegates to switch places.

Procedure:
The delegates sit on chairs in a circle. There should be one chair less than there are delegates. Each delegate gets a fruit e.g. banana, apple, pear, orange.
One of the delegates stands in the middle of the circle and says the name of the fruit e.g. if he says apple, all the apples must change seats. The delegate in the middle can now sit again if he finds a free seat. The delegate who is left without a seat must now go into the middle and the game begins again. If the delegate in the middle says "Fruit Salad", all pupils must change seat.

Equipment: None.

Giants, Wizards and Dwarfs

Purpose:
This is a team approach to the ancient game of rock, paper, and scissors. It is a great game to use with a group to encourage communication and teamwork.

Procedure:
The key to the game is this:

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Wizards cast spells on giants. Giants squish dwarfs. Dwarfs are small and quick and outsmart wizards. The game begins with teams huddling together, deciding which creatures the team will be. The entire team must be the same creature at the same time. As soon as the teams have decided on their creature, they line up face to face with the opposing team, in rows about four feet apart. On the leader's command team members jump to their pose. A point is scored on the basis of which creature beats which. If both teams form the same creature, no point is scored and teams return to their huddle to decide their next team move. The first team to score 5-7 points wins. Keep games short. Sides can be scrambled, and the game played again to avoid any emphasis on competition.

Motions:

- Giants: Stand tall. Arms straight over head. Fingers curled ready to grab. Voices give loud "growl".
- Wizards: Crouch slightly. Arms extended, fingers extended to cast spell. Eyes lurk behind arms. Voice a wizardry "hiss".
- Dwarfs: Crouch down on haunches. Hands and arms in front puppy style. Voice one loud "ha".

Equipment: None.

Grandmother's Footsteps

Procedure:
In this game one person is chosen to be Grandmother and stands, with eyes shut, facing a wall. The other players line up at the opposite side of the room and, when everyone is ready, begin to creep up behind Grandmother. Whenever Grandmother turns around, however, everyone in the room has to freeze like a statue. Grandmother may look around as often as he or she likes, and when he or she catches someone moving then that person has to go back to the wall and begin again. The first player to touch the wall wins and takes the next turn at being Grandmother.

Equipment: None.

Human Knot

Purpose:
This is an exercise in team work.

Procedure:
The delegates form a tight circle with everyone facing the middle.
Everyone puts their hands in the centre of the circle and grasps the hands of two other people (not those of either of the people standing next to them.)
When this is completed, the group must then untangle the knot they have created. Physical hand-to-hand contact may not be broken to untangle the knot. Grips may change and palms may pivot on one another, but contact must be maintained.
This will sometimes result in two interlinked circles, or two separate circles, but it's always possible to get into a circle. I've had people tell me that it can be proven impossible. It's been empirically shown to be possible!
If time is running out, the problem can be simplified by breaking one grip and asking the group to form a single line instead of a circle.
If this task is completed correctly, the delegates should end up in a circle again.

Variations:
Different variations on this exercise include appointing one student as the spokesperson, and requiring all others remain silent. Or to appoint one student as the spokesperson, and have all other students close their eyes and work only by feel and listening to the spokesperson verbal directions.

Equipment: None.

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Killer Car

Procedure:
Players form into pairs which one player holding the arm of the other. One pair is the killer car and must chase the other pairs. If another pair is tagged they become the chasers. If the pair is separated they are not allowed to tag anyone until they join up again.

Variation:
Blindfold half of the committee and have their pair to give them orders where to go.

Equipment: None.

Pass The Pulse

Procedure:
Everybody intertwines their arms and holds hands with their eyes closed. The facilitator is the generator of the "pulse". The facilitator starts with passing the "pulse" by squeezing the hand of the person to their right or left. The person who just received the pulse then squeezes the other hand he or she is holding, and the process continues on throughout the group. The pulse should travel around the circle a couple of times, with the facilitator passing it just like everyone else. When this pulse is travelling, you can send a new pulse. Then game ends when the facilitator progressively stop all of the pulses.

Equipment: None.

Simon Says

Procedure:
One player is chosen as the leader, and the others stand around the room in front of him or her. The leader then gives commands that the others should either follow or ignore, depending on how the command is given. If the leader begins the command with "Simon says", then everyone should carry out his or her command. For example, if he or she says, "Simon says touch your toes", then the others should bend over and touch their toes. If, however, the leader just says, "Touch your toes", then the order should be ignored. If someone follows an order that did not have "Simon says" before it, then he or she is eliminated.
The leader can also mislead the other players by giving out the orders very fast, by carrying out him or her commands that were not preceded by "Simon Says", or by creating a rhythm of orders in a pattern that is then suddenly broken by a wrong command. The last player to be caught out is the winner and takes the place of the leader.

Equipment: None.

Skin The Snake

Procedure:
All delegates line up one behind another. Each delegate puts their right hand forward as if they were shaking a person's hand. Put left hand through own legs behind to shake hands with person behind you.
Without breaking the chain, start the game. The last person in the line lies down on their back. Everyone else backs up to be able to lie down also. When whole group is lying down, first person stands up, and walks forward over all the other people until the "snake" has skinned itself. Be careful not to step on them!

Equipment: None.

Sticky Toffee

Procedure:
Keeping two participants out, have everyone lie down and hold on to each other in one big bundle, the more tangled the better. For these people the aim of the game is to be one of the two last people to be lying on the playing surface. This is accomplished by holding on to other participants utilising their most vice like grip.
It falls to the two people left over to be the ones who have to separate the participants, untangling the "Sticky Toffee". One can use brute strength and or cunning.
Once a person is separated from the group she/he helps untangling.
The game is won when there are only two people left on the playing surface. These two are then the beginners of the next round.

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The delegates should be bare-foot in order to avoid injury. You should also have a relatively soft surface to play upon, e.g. carpet, mattress, grass.

Tactics:

- During the initial dive to the relatively soft surface, being on the bottom of the pile, although potentially crush worthy, is a good way to guarantee success. The initial aim should be to knot one another's limbs together as much as possible.
- To avoid being pulled away, thrashing loose limbs around as much as possible is advisable.
- The *Tickling Gambit*: The controversial *Tickling Gambit* often needs to be brought into play to separate particularly entangled players. Not surprisingly, it involves tickling someone in order to make him or her lose their grip on another player. Any rules concerning tickle rationing should be agreed upon before play begins. A maximum of three tickles for each separator is a good number. If a game is going well, this rule will be broken continually throughout.

Equipment: None.

There Ain't No Flies On Me

Procedure:
The group should be divided in two parts and placed on each short side of a rectangular plane. The first group starts and takes one step towards the centre of the plane, saying "There ain't no flies on me". They take another two steps and finish the third step by saying "But there are some flies on you". The other group does the same. When they have taken their third step and the two groups are facing each other – the first group says "Kaboom". The task is now for each group to bring the other group's members to their side. Once brought to the other side you become a member of the new group. Only one team will win.

Note:
Be careful!

Equipment: None.

Viking

Procedure:
All of the players sit in a circle. One person starts as the Viking by putting their fingers at their side of their head like horns on their hat. This Viking passes the role of being a Viking by pointing their horns at someone. If you are pointed at, you become a Viking (horns and all) and the person on the right has to start paddling to the right and the person on the left has to start paddling on the left. The last person of the threesome to assume their position is out. The rest of the players slap their legs during the game in a constant rhythm.

Equipment: None.

Zip Zap Zop

Purpose:
To listen to each other.

Procedure:
Someone begins by pointing to another player to one side of them and says 'zip'. That player turns to the next player in the circle, points to them and says 'zip'. Thus the 'zip' zips around the circle in one direction. At any time a receiving player can say 'zap' to the person pointing at them. When they do the player that said 'zip' and was pointing at them must change direction of the pointing. This means that they must quickly turn around, point and say 'zip' to the person that just pointed at them. Now the 'zip' can zip around the circle, but changing direction every time there is a 'zap'. Lastly the person that receives the 'zip' may elect to yell 'zop' and point at someone anywhere in the circle. That player then restarts the 'zip' going in the direction of their choice. The group must really pay attention for this to work.

Equipment: None.

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Later energisers

Coin Game

Procedure:
The delegates lie on their backs on the floor. The first delegate in order receives a coin on his or her stomach. The coin should then be transported to the next person in the line. This is done when the second person turns over to the first one (who has the coin), they squeeze together and then both turn over. The coin should then be on the second person's stomach.

Equipment: A coin.

Have you ever?

Purpose:
To get to know each other even closer. You can definitely learn a lot about people with this game.

Procedure:
Put tape of small pieces of paper to mark spots for people to stand in two lines facing each other. If you have 10 people, put down 9. Leave enough room between the lines for plenty of movement.
The person without a spot stands in the middle and asks a question. "Have you ever eaten a kiwi?" Everyone who can say yes, they've eaten a kiwi must then leave their space and find a new one. They cannot stay in the same spot or move to a spot immediately to their right or left. Everyone who can say no, they haven't eaten a kiwi stays on their spot. While people are running to find a new spot, hopefully the person that asked the question can find a spot too. Whoever is left without a spot now asks the next question. The only requirement on questions is that it must be true for the person asking it. So, if they ask "Have you ever stolen anything?" must have at some point stolen something.

Note:
This is not a game for the first meeting!

Equipment: Small pieces of paper.

Honey Tell Me That You Love Me

Procedure:
Sitting in a circle, one person is in the centre, approaches someone and says, "Honey tell me that you love me" (alternative "Honey if you love me please smile"). The person must respond without smiling, "Honey I love you but I just can't smile." Aside from tickling, the player may do anything to make the person smile. If the person smiles while saying this, then they must switch places.

Equipment: None.

Pass the orange

Procedure:
This is best played when two committees compete. Arrange for your delegates to stand in a line, one behind the other (arranged boy, girl, boy...). Give the first delegate in the line an orange which the first person should place under his chin. This should be passed to the person behind but neither may use their hands. If the orange drops, those two people have to do it again. When the orange gets to the last person, they come to the front of the line and start again. The winning team is the first one which gets their starting person to the front again.

Variation:
This can be made more complicated to have them passing a bottle / cucumber between their legs at the same time as the orange. You can also add football to be passed between stomachs.

Equipment: An orange, ball or similar.

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Suck and Blow

Procedure:
Everyone sits in a circle, generally male - female. Someone chooses to start, and places the card against his/her lips, then using nothing but air pressure passes it to the person sitting next to him. This person takes the card by sucking on it and attempts to pass it to the next person, of course, never touching the card with hands. If the card is dropped during the exchange it starts over again.

Specific purpose:
A classic game for the purpose to make people get closer.

Variation:
There is another version where after the card is dropped, it is torn in half, and then the game continues. Eventually, there become more lips involved in the exchange than actual card.

Equipment: A good-sized index card or sheet of paper.

Zulu Dance

If you look at me a zulu you can see
If you dance with me a zulu you can be
Hey - Zulu - Attention - ...

1. [...] – right hand
2. [...] – right hand - left hand
3. [...] – right hand - left hand - right foot
4. [...] – right hand - left hand - right foot - left foot
5. [...] – right hand - left hand - right foot - left foot - down
6. [...] – right hand - left hand - right foot - left foot - down – around

Equipment: None.

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Trust

Drunken Bottle

Procedure:
This is an exercise of trust and teamwork. Delegates stand in a tight circle with shoulders touching, and with each student focused on the centre, where one of the other students is standing (this student should be a volunteer). When all of the students are focused, instruct the student in the centre that he/she is to stand with ankles together and heels planted on the ground, knees straight. The delegate should stands as straight and stiff as possible. He/she will then be instructed to fall, trusting the students in the circle to catch him/her, and not allow him/her to fall to the ground. The students in the circle should be instructed to help each other, and not allow the centre student to fall, gently stopping his/her descent and redirecting it in another direction.
The purpose is trust building, that the individual gain trust. Once comfortable, the person in the centre closes his or her eyes.

Tips:
Everyone in the group should try this.

Note:
There should be NO shoving or forceful movements of the centre student. This should be an exercise of trust and *not* one of scaring the centre student. As many students as possible should be allowed to participate in this activity, but none should be forced if it is obvious that they are truly uncomfortable with it.

Equipment: None.

Trust Walk

Purpose:
This is an exercise in trust, focus, and using senses other than sight for information.

Procedure:
Delegates are taken outside if possible. Explain to the delegates that they will be going on a trust walk and that they are instructed to find a partner. One of the pair is instructed to close their eyes and be guided around the space determined. Tell them that they will be blindfolded part of the time and will be responsible for the safety of their blindfolded partner the rest of the time. Have them get in a buddy line. Blindfold one of each of the pairs. Have the "sighted" delegates tell the blindfolded delegate to go forward, up hill, etc... Have the "sighted" partner hold the arm of the blindfolded person; as safety not to direct their unsighted partner. The guide should bring their partner near objects in the space such as trees, tables and other students to have the blind student determine what, or who, it is they are touching.

Equipment: Blindfolds for half.

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Communication

Following Directions

Procedure:
Form pairs. Give each person a piece of paper. The partner sit back to back, such that one person cannot see the hands and paper of the other person. One person is designated the creator. By tearing and folding, s/he creates a shape/structure out of his paper. As s/he does this, s/he tells his/her partner how to create the shape. The person following directions is not allowed to ask questions. After a few minutes, the pairs face each other and compare completed shapes. Then, roles are switched. This time, the person following directions is allowed to ask questions. Afterwards, discuss how the experiences differed, and how communication is important.

Equipment: A piece of paper, pens or pencils.

Story Telling

Purpose:
This activity shows how information travels, and how it is often important to have information written down instead of communicated by voice.

Procedure:
Three persons go out into the hall or in some other way isolated from the group. A story is told to the group. No notes are allowed. The story should be about two to three minutes in length, and contain many details. Then, one of the isolated people is called in. A group member repeats the story as s/he remembers it to the isolated person. Then another isolated person is called in. The first isolated person tells the story to the second. The pattern repeats until all the isolated people have heard the story. During this time, the audience is not to make any comments about the story. After everyone has heard the story, the audience is allowed to comment on the version told by the last person. After all comments have been made, the original story is read again.

Equipment: None.

Telephone Game

Purpose:
This is supposed to demonstrate the need/importance of getting information first hand.

Procedure:
Everyone line up in a row, usually against a wall. At one end, a message is whispered into the first person's ear such that no other person can hear what is said. The message is passed from person to person, until the last person gets it. This person announces to the group the message s/he received. The originating person also announces the original message. During message passing, no repeating of the message is allowed. The final message is often quite different from the original.

Equipment: None.

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Cooperation

Blind search

Procedure:
Pick out approximately 5 objects that the group members can look at/touch. Send them out of the room and blindfold them. When they come back in the objects are hidden in the room and the group has to work together to find them. They have 5 minutes. Don't tell them anything about why they did this exercise, but promise them that they will know in the end of the project. Do the same exercise during the evaluation of the project, but this time, ask the group what roles they had and if they did anything different from the first time.

Specific purpose:
Define roles. Communication. Working together as a team. Development through a project/process.

Tips:
Define a quite small area where you hide the objects. Be sure to promise the participants that they will learn the purpose later.

Equipment: Approximately 5 objects. Blindfolds for the whole group.

Caterpillar

Purpose:
This game is very good for team building, because all members are part of it (no matter if they are shy or something else). At the beginning it's very funny, and at the end they are all happy for fulfilling the assignment successfully.

Procedure:
The delegates are lined up. You tie their ankles together. They can't move unless they make a rhythm. They all have to work together, and if only one of them is wrong, they all have difficulty in moving, and the goal should be 10 metres from the start (for example!).

Equipment: Ropes.

Magic Stick

Procedure:
The delegates have a long stick. Using the underside of their index finger the stick should be moved horizontally, first up and then down. The movements should be coordinated, that is the movement of the stick should be smooth and gentle. All the delegates' fingers must be used.

Variation:
Let everyone but one delegate be blindfolded.

Equipment: A long stick.

River Game

Procedure:
Divide the committee in two groups. There is a river between the two groups of about 50 centimetres in the beginning.
The group which starts is to transport a small object (e.g. a ball) to the group on the other side of the river without throwing it. However the river is on its way to overflow so for each time one of the groups succeeds to transport the object, the gap between them is increased. Don't increase the gap too quickly!
The group is to co-operate when the gap is getting bigger and bigger in order to get the object handed over to the other group.

Equipment: A small object, e.g. a ball.

Silent Killer

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Purpose:
This is an exercise of focus and using senses other than sight for information.

Procedure:
The delegates are given a space with in which to move. They are told to feel the space, and move freely. They are then instructed to close their eyes, and to continue to move throughout the space. Here is where the killer is chosen. The facilitator should tap one of the students on the head, signifying that they are the killer. This is done silently. The killer, still with their eyes closed, is required to move around the space and find their victims.
The only person who should be attempting to touch anyone else is the killer. When they find a victim, the killer grabs that victim on the shoulder, arm, etc. The victim then dies with a melodramatic final scream (giving a clue to the other potential victims where the killer is, or at least was). The game can be moved along by using the victims who are already dead to close in a tighter space, tightening up the circle in which the delegates are moving.

Equipment: None.

Volcano Game

Purpose:
This exercise is supposed to develop creative skills and teamwork.

Procedure:
Place the container, half-filled, in the centre of a circle which is about 10 feet in diameter. The goal is to get the container out of the circle. The circle is filled with "lava". No one can touch it. Anyone who touches it is dead and cannot help the cause.

Equipment: For this game, you need a lightweight, open container capable of holding about 2 quarts water, and some rope that is at least 1/4" thick, about 30 feet or more. You also need some way of marking the circle.

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Projects / Planning / Problem Solving

Blind Square

Procedure:
The object of this game is to have a group of at least eight players form a perfect square while blindfolded. After the players have put on blindfolds, place a rope that is tied in a circle, in each person's hands. Players must then form the rope into the shape of a square. When they believe the square has been formed, they place the rope carefully on the ground and remove their blindfolds. All players must have at least one hand on the rope at all times.

Equipment: A large rope tied in a circle and blindfolds.

IKEA Game (also called "Replication")

Purpose:
The IKEA game builds communication skills and is a good teambuilding effort. It's fun too to look at the different results.

Procedure:
The organisers of the game begin by finding multiples of objects. You should have at least 8 different objects (sweatshirts, jackets, cell phones, pens, glasses etc). Then, where none of the participants can see, arrange one set of the objects. Maybe place the pen horizontally in the middle of the binder open to page 4 and put the pinecone centred above the binder.
Then gather the delegates and split them into three groups and explain the game. Each group has 2 builders, 1 or 2 runners, and 1 looker. The looker gets to see the original model.
The builders get a pile of the same objects in a separate room from the other builders, or at least where they can't see or hear the other groups. The runners are spaced between. The interaction goes like this: The lookers look at the original and go half or a third of the way towards the rooms with the builders and meets the runner. This spot must be the same distance for each group. The looker tells the runner all of the details he can remember about the model. Then the runner goes to the builders.
When the runner gets to the builders, the builders can only ask the runner yes or no questions. "Does the pen go here? Is the binder open? Is it open to this page? To this page?" As a facilitator you make sure the runner only says yes or no. When the runner can't remember anymore details or wants to confirm a detail, they go back to the point where they can meet the looker. They can converse freely about the details. This back and forth goes on until all of the groups feel they are done or are pretty much done. Then everyone gets together and looks at each groups finished model. Then everyone can go and look at the original.

Equipment: As above.

Multilegged Monster

Procedure:
Group of 10: 6 legs, Groups of 12: 8 legs
The group is tied together and has to get from one place to the other.

Built it!

Each delegate can see a thing once, and then they have to build it.

Equipment: None.

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Murder Mystery

Procedure:
The players sit in a circle facing inwards. One player, the detective is taken away where he can not see or hear the others. One of the players in the circle is designated as the murderer. The players are told a secret signal (e.g. a hand signal). The detective is then returned to the circle where he must guess the identity of the murderer before he kills everyone. If any of the players notes the signal coming from the murderer he must 'die' in some dramatic fashion. The detective only has a limited number of guesses in which to guess the identity of the murderer (by pointing at them). If the detective fails to guess in time, the murderer takes his place and play continues anew. 3 guesses is a sensible number for most groups.

Equipment: None.

Plane Wreck Game

Purpose:
See how successful your committee is at forming consensus.

Procedure:
Your committee is presented with this scenario: the people in the group were on a plan when it crashed in the desert. The plane is on fire and will soon explode. They must determine which five items they will retrieve from the plane to help them survive in the desert.
The items available are:

- life vest
- 2-way radio
- picture of Chairman Mao
- crate of army rations
- book of matches
- flashlight with batteries
- case of three emergency flares
- mirror
- map of surrounding area
- sextant
- compass
- water purification tablets

The individuals are to choose the five items that they wish to save. At this point they are not to discuss their choices with the other group members. Then, give five minutes to talk as a group to reach consensus. After the second period, the place explodes.
Talk about how choices were made. Was voting necessary? Did everyone agree at the beginning? How were tough decisions made? Did any compromising take place?

Equipment: A sheet with the items to choose between.

Spider's Web

Specific purpose:
This assignment is very physical and seems hard to accomplish. If it succeeds (as it usually does) the team often get very excited and get much closer. The assignment requires everybody to participate and make people feel like a team.

Procedure:
With the use of rope you make a spider web between for example two trees. The openings in the web has to be big enough for people to climb trough them. The whole group has to stand on one side and the assignment is to get to the other side without touching the web. They can only use each opening once. The time limit can vary, but if it is about 12 people they should manage to do it in 15 to 20 minutes. If you want to make the assignment more difficult, you can blindfold some of the group or shorten the time limit. After the assignment it is important to ask the group about the experience, did someone take charge, which factors was important to succeed and so forth.

Tips:

- Make sure that the web has openings with different sizes.
- Try the assignment yourselves before you facilitate it.

Equipment: Lengths of strong rope, two poles or trees.

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Traffic Jam

Procedure:
There should be two equal subgroups. Place two persons facing each other about 1 metre apart so that there's an empty space in the middle. Form equal lines behind them.
Starting formation: xxxxxx oooooo
Finishing formation: oooooo xxxxxx

The groups have to swap without illegal moves.
Legal moves:
(1) a person may move into an empty space directly in front of him or her.
(2) You may move around a person who is facing you to get to an open space.

Certain restrictions:
(1) Only one driver can move at a time.
(2) You must always face the direction you are currently facing.
(3) You may not move around a driver facing the same direction as you.
(4) You may not move backwards.
This game is solvable, and is in fact quite easy to do once the algorithm is determined.

Equipment: None.

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Others

Brainstorming Game

Purpose:
This exercise is used to develop brainstorming skills.

Procedure:
The committee is given the situation: A shoe company has somehow made 1000 left shoes. It, for some reason, cannot manufacture the right shoes. It wants to sell the left shoes, but doesn't know how. The committee is to solve the problem.
The "rules" of brainstorming dictate that no idea be shot down, and that no ideas be discussed. They are simply written down by each delegate on post-it notes. After five minutes of brainstorming, stop.
The committee reports its results. Did people follow the rules? How were new ideas generated?

Equipment: Post-its, pens or pencils.

Jig Saw

Purpose:
This is fun to spur interaction between delegates as you begin the session.

Procedure:
As each delegate enters the room, give them a piece of a puzzle. (These should be simple puzzles with a relatively small number of pieces.) The delegates must cooperate with the other members to find out which puzzle they belong to and where their piece fits. This will help the participants work together to accomplish a task.

Equipment: A puzzle.

Warm Fuzzies

Procedure:
Cut squares of paper. Brainstorm a list of positive characteristics about other people (for example, kind, cheerful, considerate, fun, sincere, friendly, humorous, responsible, warm, empathic, loyal, unselfish). Invite participants to choose one positive characteristic from the list that best describes each person in the group. On one side of a square of paper, write the name of the person; on the other side, write a positive characteristic. When everyone is finished, hand the square to the person. Each person can place the squares in an envelope and enjoy their "warm fuzzies".

Equipment: Paper cut into squares (enough so each person has a square for each other person in the group), pen or pencil for each delegate and one envelope for each delegate

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Useful links

There are lots of different websites dedicated to teambuilding and teambuilding activities. Here are some:

http://www.funandgames.org/active_teamgame.htm

http://www.geocities.com/Heartland/Acres/6690/30sec_1.htm

http://home.online.no/~steinny

http://www.ipt.com/yarps/Resource%20Files/games.html

http://www.kakaopistoler.tk

http://www.karl.aegee.org/aeg-IntE.NSF/9afb6a211e17102bc1256322004f24ea/91c35c30c8b280aac1256942007b0505?OpenDocument

http://www.kprbc.org.sg/kensapp/games.html

http://www.primaryresources.co.uk/pe/outdoor.htm

http://www.scoutbase.org.uk/activity/games/idx/allgames.htm

http://www.teamworkandteamplay.com/raccooncircles.html

http://web.mit.edu/mit-ceti/www/intranet/tips/teaching/icebreakers/teambuild.htm

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